Azure Hybrid Insider

Alexander Ortha

27. Februar 2026 um 11 Uhr

#2

News & Roadmap

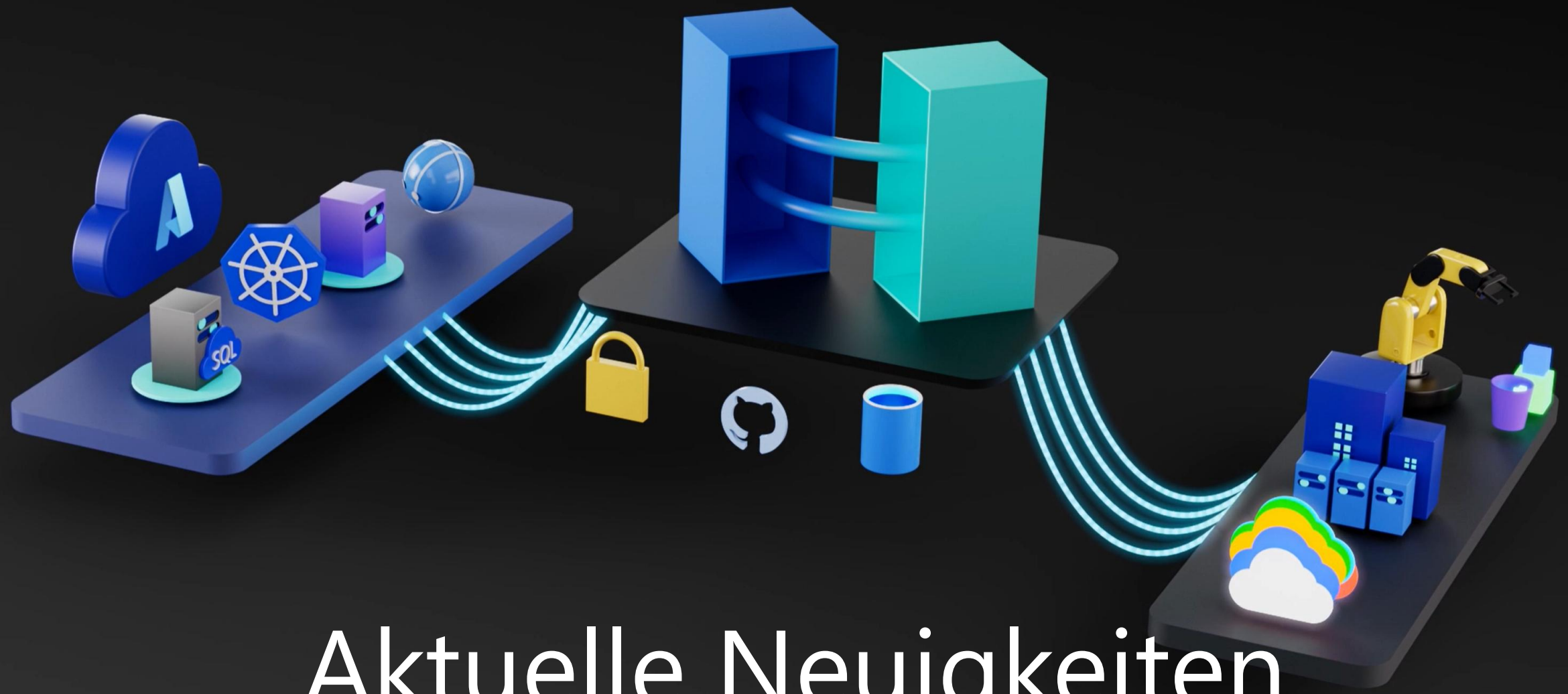
Azure Local VMs – Was, Warum, Wieso

Willkommen

Agenda / Abschnitte / Themen

- Aktuelle Neuigkeiten
- Ausblick / Roadmap / Preview
- Detailwissen
- Tipps & Tricks
- Fragen aus der Community
- Events

Recap
Arc Agent Auto Upgrade



Aktuelle Neuigkeiten

Version 1.61 - February 2026

Download for Windows or Linux

Expand table

Feature	Windows	Linux	Change Type
Guest Config	**1.29.105.0**	**1.26.105.0**	
Fixed support for security baseline customization on localized operating systems.	✓	✓	Bug Fix
Resolved an issue where upgrading the Run Command extension caused previously executed commands to re-run.	✓	✓	Bug Fix
Fixed a bug that caused extension enable operations to time out prematurely.	✓	✓	Bug Fix
Improved reliability of GPG signature validation of extensions on Linux distributions.		✓	Improvement
Update OpenSSL to 3.6.1 for improved security and performance.	✓	✓	Improvement
Azcmagent	**1.61.03310.2719**	**1.61.03310848**	
Added support for ARM64 Oracle 8, x86_64 Oracle 10, and Debian 13.		✓	Feature
Auto upgrade script now respects proxy configuration on Linux.		✓	Improvement
Added option to disable automatic upgrades locally.	✓	✓	Feature
Added MSI signature verification to the Windows installation script for enhanced security.	✓		Improvement
Fixed a bug in the Linux install script where the wrong package manager was invoked on some distributions.		✓	Bug Fix
Fix bug where serial number is not detected by `azcmagent connect` command, causing certificate-based authentication to fail.	✓		Bug Fix
Fix bug causing installation to fail on machines with .NET < 4.5.1.	✓		Bug Fix

Features and improvements in 2602

The February 2026 release of hyperconverged deployments of Azure Local is version **12.2602.1002.7**. For more information, see Release information summary.

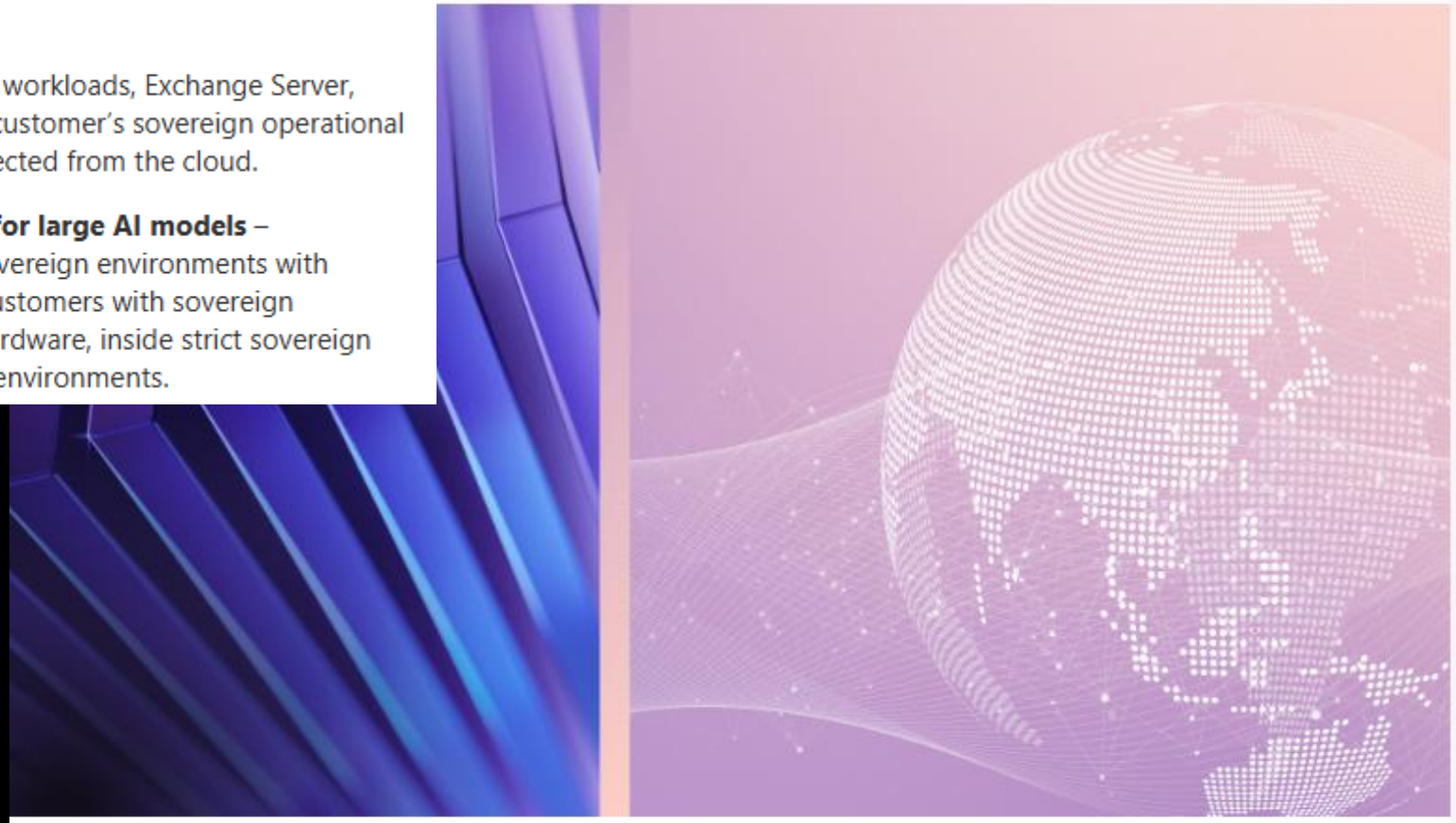
This release includes various reliability improvements and other bug fixes.

- **OS changes:**
  - In 2602 release, all the new and existing deployments of Azure Local run the new OS version **26100.32370** (download from the Azure portal).
  - You also need a driver that's compatible with OS version **26100.32370** or Windows Server 2025.
  - For Integrated System or Premier solution hardware from the Azure Local Catalog, the OS is preinstalled. Work with your Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM) to get a compatible OS image and a compatible driver.
- **.NET updates:** This build uses .NET version **8.0.24** for both .NET Runtime and ASP.NET Core. For more information, see Download .NET 8.0.
- **Enhanced update workflow from the Azure portal:** Starting with this release, the update workflow from the Azure portal now provides richer, more detailed information.
- **End of Windows Server Subscription and Extended Security Updates (ESU) purchases for OS version 20349.xxxx (22H2):** If running OS version 20349.xxxx (version 22H2), you can no longer purchase Windows Server Subscription or ESU.

Microsoft Sovereign Cloud adds governance, productivity and support for large AI models securely running even when completely disconnected

Feb 24, 2026 | Douglas Phillips - President and Chief Technology Officer, Microsoft Specialized Clouds

- **Azure Local disconnected operations (now available)** – Organizations can now run mission-critical infrastructure with Azure governance and policy control, with no cloud connectivity, optimizing continuity for sovereign, classified or isolated environments.
- **Microsoft 365 Local disconnected (now available)** – Core productivity workloads, Exchange Server, SharePoint Server and Skype for Business Server can run fully inside the customer's sovereign operational boundary on Azure Local, keeping teams productive even when disconnected from the cloud.
- **Foundry Local adds modern infrastructure capabilities and support for large AI models** – Organizations can now bring large AI models into fully disconnected, sovereign environments with Foundry Local. Using modern infrastructure from partners like NVIDIA, customers with sovereign needs will now be able to run multimodal models locally on their own hardware, inside strict sovereign boundaries enabling powerful, local AI inferencing in fully disconnected environments.



https://www.linkedin.com/posts/alexanderortha_microsoft-sovereign-cloud-adds-governance-activity-7432034265736912897-2KMS

[Plan for Windows Server 2016 and Windows 10 2016 LTSB end of support - Windows IT Pro Blog]

WINDOWS IT PRO BLOG 4 MIN READ

Plan for Windows Server 2016 and Windows 10 2016 LTSB end of support

SarthakAgrawal MICROSOFT
Feb 20, 2026

Three Windows products first released in 2016 are close to reaching end of support (EOS) on the following dates:

- Windows 10 Enterprise LTSB 2016: October 13, 2026
- Windows 10 IoT Enterprise 2016 LTSB: October 13, 2026
- Windows Server 2016: January 12, 2027

If your organization still uses the products listed above, your devices will receive a final monthly security update on these dates. After that, these devices will no longer receive Windows security updates, non-security updates, bug fixes, technical support, or online technical content updates.

The good news? If you need additional time, you can use the Extended Security Updates (ESU) program.

> **Note**: The Long-Term Servicing Branch (LTSB) is an older term for the currently used Long-Term Servicing Channel (LTSC). You might see these used interchangeably across different sources. Learn more about this release channel, which is designed for special-purpose devices only.

What is the Extended Security Update program?

The ESU program is not intended to be a long-term solution but rather a temporary bridge.

- **What Extended Security Updates are:** The ESU program offers critical and important security updates only (as defined by the Microsoft Security Response Center). Technical support is limited to the activation of the ESU licenses, installation of ESU monthly updates, and addressing issues that may have been caused by an update.
- **What Extended Security Updates are not:** Extended Security Updates do not include new features, quality fixes, or design change requests. The ESU program does not extend technical support for Windows 10 Enterprise LTSB 2016, Windows IoT Enterprise LTSB 2016, or Windows Server 2016.

Extended Security Updates are available for purchase for up to three years after the end of the mainstream support date.

Plan for Windows Server 2016 end of support
Don’t forget SQL 2016

Inplace Upgrade to Windows Server 2025
N-4

ESU by Azure Arc

ODIN | Designer | Knowledge | Sizer PREVIEW | Feedback

⚠ **Disclaimer:** This tool is provided as-is, without Microsoft support. Odin is an experimental project that accelerates skills and knowledge ramp up for Azure Local, and helps IT architects validate cluster design configurations.

Odin for Azure Local

Odin, the Norse god embodying strategic thinking and architecture, is your guide for Azure Local deployments. This **O**ptimal **D**eployment and **I**nfrastructure **N**avigator provides a decision tree interface to select an Azure Local deployment type, and instance design using validated architecture and network configuration.

Page Views: **4,569** | Designs Generated: **376** | ARM Deployments: **190** | Sizes Calculated: **59**

Version 0.17.04 | What's New

01 Deployment Type

Help and information for Deployment Types

Hyperconverged

Single rack, or rack-aware cluster providing hyperconverged compute, storage and network.

Multi-Rack

Scalable, multi-rack distributed architecture.

Disconnected

Air-gapped operation with local management.

M365 Local

Microsoft 365 workloads with minimum 9 nodes.

Progress 0% • 0/20

Font: A− A+

CONFIGURATION SUMMARY

Select options to see summary...

Load Example Configuration Template

Import | Export

Start Over

Odin for Azure Local

Ausblick / Roadmap / Preview

Nov. 2024

Azure Local with low cost hardware @ Youtube

[Announcing Public Preview: Simplified Machine Provisioning for Azure Local | Microsoft Community Hub]

Announcing Public Preview: Simplified Machine Provisioning for Azure Local

PragyaDwivedi MICROSOFT
Feb 26, 2026

Deploying infrastructure at the edge has always been challenging.

Whether it's retail stores, factories, branch offices, or remote sites, getting servers racked, configured, and ready for workloads often require skilled IT staff on-site. That process is slow, expensive, and error-prone, especially when deployments need to happen at scale.

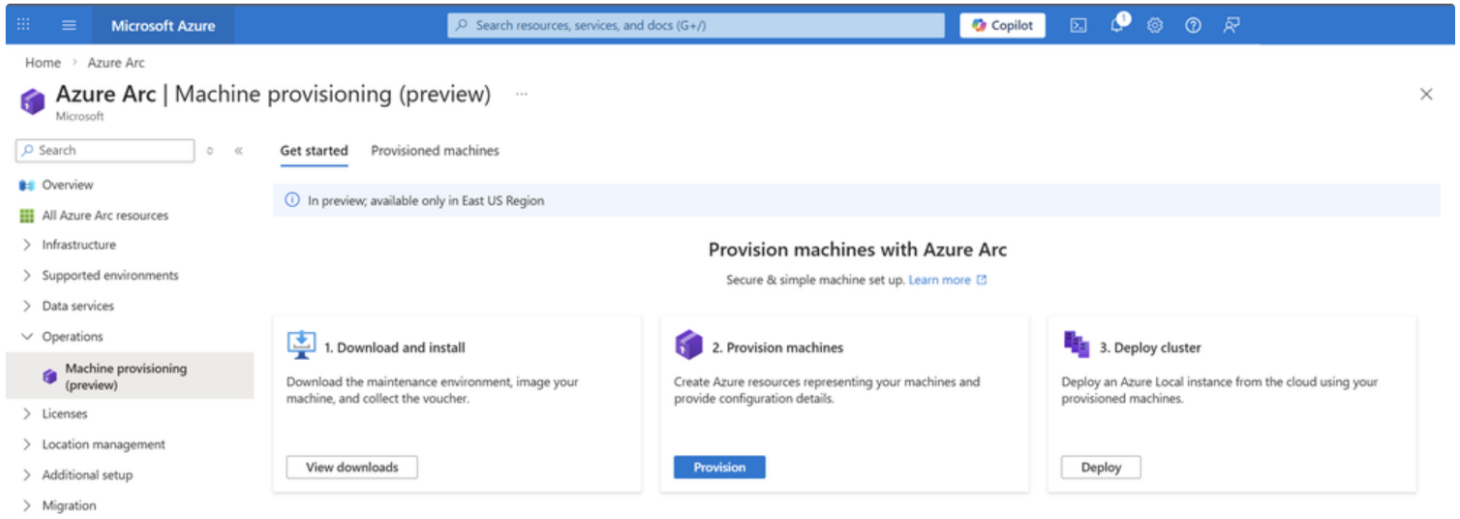
To address this, we're introducing **Public Preview of Simplified Machine Provisioning for Azure Local -** a new way to provision Azure Local hardware with minimal onsite interaction, while maintaining centralized control through Azure. This new approach enables customers to provision hardware by racking, powering on, and letting *Azure do the rest*.

New Machine Provisioning

Simplified machine provisioning shifts configuration to Azure, reducing the need for technical expertise on-site.

Instead of manually configuring each server locally, IT teams can now:

- Define provisioning configuration centrally in Azure
- Securely complete provisioning remotely with minimal steps
- Automate provisioning workflows using ARM templates and ensure consistency across sites

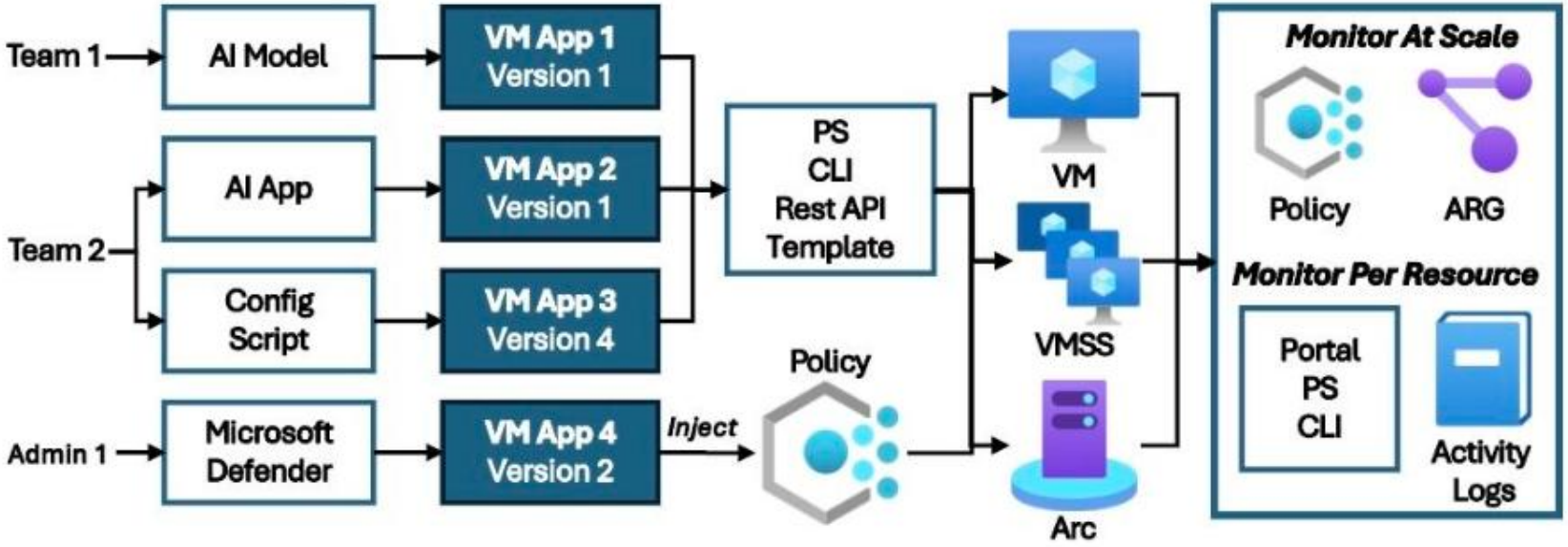


Learn More: **Aka.ms/VMApplications**

VM Applications

Managed & one stop solution for VM software lifecycle management

- Faster, modular, scalable & resilient deployments vs scripts.
- Private app gallery with role-based access controls
- Inventory monitoring & governance
- Replica per region for faster creates & resiliency



[Overview of VM Applications in the Azure Compute Gallery - Azure Virtual Machines | Microsoft Learn]

[Software Management on Azure Arc - Private Preview Signup]

Detailwissen
Azure Local VMs

Unterschiede Arc enabled Server vs. Arc enabled VM

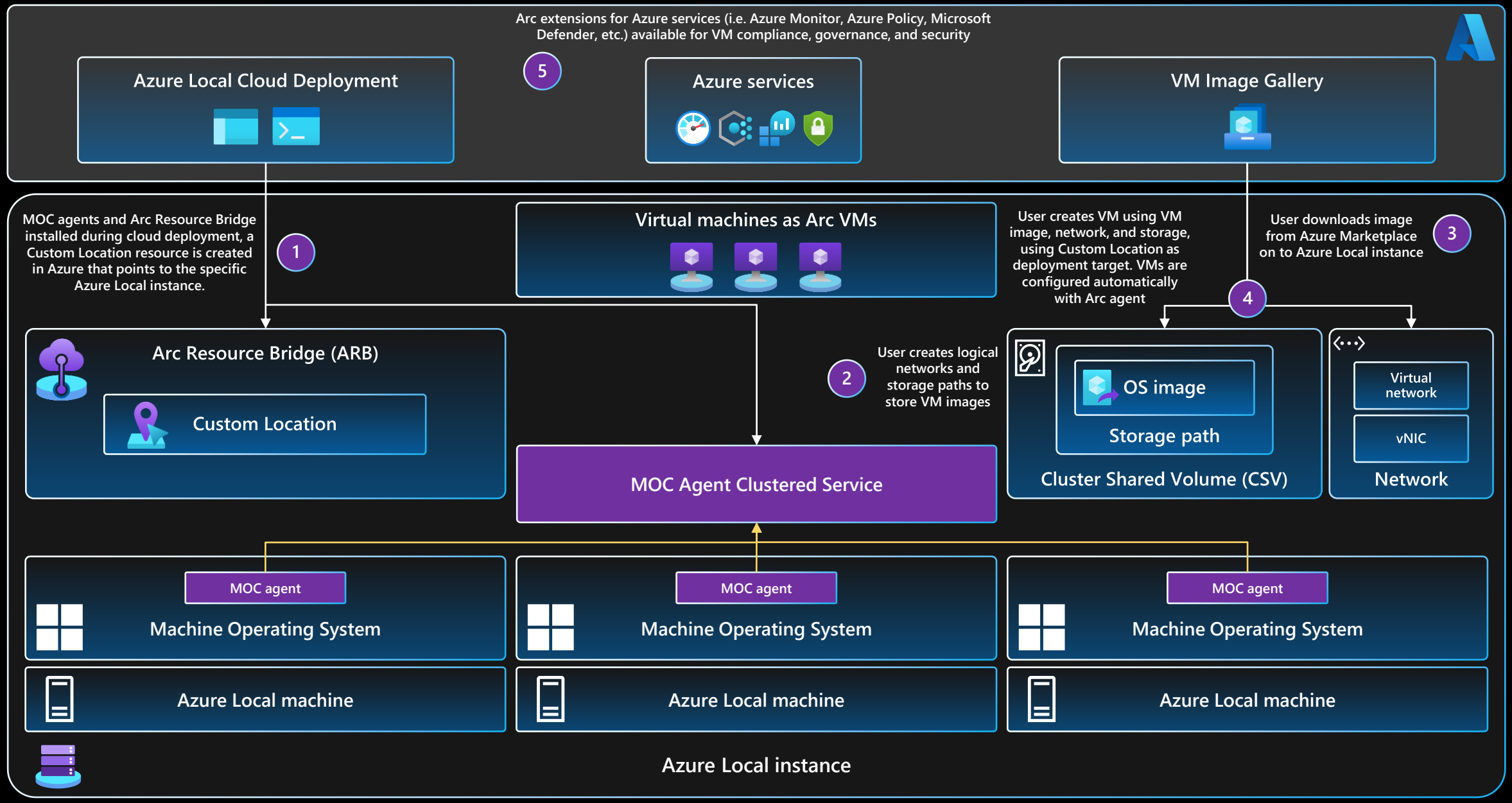
Documented: [Compare management capabilities of VMs on Azure Local]

	Unmanaged VMs	**Arc-enabled servers**	**Azure Local VMs enabled by Azure Arc**
Provisioning method	Local tools - Failover Cluster Manager - Hyper-V Manager - Windows Admin Center - Virtual Machine Manager - PowerShell	By deploying the Connected Machine agent	- Azure Local VM provisioning - Azure Migrate - (Hydration)
Management method	Local tools	Azure Portal/CLI	Azure Portal/CLI/ARM/BICEP/TF
Past name	Non-Arc VM Hyper-V VM	--	Azure Arc VM, also • Arc-managed VM • Arc-enabled VM • Arc VM on Azure Local

Aktionen welche erlaubt bzw. nicht erlaubt sind

Supported Operations for Azure Local Virtual Machines (VMs) Enabled by Azure Arc - Azure Local | Microsoft Learn

Azure Local – Arc virtual machine architecture



Erstellen einer Azure Local VM

- Portal
- ARM Template
- Azure CLI / (PowerShell)
- Bicep
- Terraform

Some hints

- VM and vNIC always in the same RG
- It seems, there are a few bugs in the CLI
  - image should be in the same RG as the VM
    - → only with CLI, ARM supports that scenario
  - Tags are not set
  - Memory will show up as dynamic insted of static

Fragen / Themenwünsche

Ausblick & Events

SESSION:
"MODERNES PATCH MANAGEMENT FÜR SERVER – WSUS IST ABGEKÜNDIGT UND JETZT?"

Alexander Ortha

- Hybrid -

Experts Live Germany

03 & 04. MÄRZ 2026 - LEIPZIG

Azure Hybrid Insider

Alexander Ortha

13. März 2026 # 11 Uhr

#3

News & Roadmap

Azure Arc / Local Monitoring – Was, Warum, Wieso

Vielen Dank!